Innovate in India

AMD AND IBM ON BUILDING THE FUTURE OF COMPUTING

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Imaging: Nikhil Wahal

It's been more than two decades since Deepak Agarwal walked into AMD as a fresh-faced Level 2 design engineer straight out of the University of Maryland. Back then, he was dabbling in performance modeling, not necessarily plotting how to co-lead a global tech giant from a modest office in Bengaluru. But as it turns out, those early decisions – to chase silicon instead of software, to return to India before it was cool, and to bet big on engineering talent – have paid off in spades.

"AMD has been my first and only company," says Deepak, now Corporate Vice President of Silicon Design Engineering and Site Lead for AMD Bengaluru. "The journey from DE2 to CVP hasn't been easy. But what makes it endearing is that it's come with immense learning, growth opportunities and the trust of AMD management in me," he says.

This sense of loyalty isn't just a personal trait, but reflects the slow-burn strategy AMD has pursued in India. Once seen as a satellite centre for engineering grunt work, AMD India now plays a pivotal role in designing everything from CPUs to AI accelerators, and is inching closer to where the future of computing – especially high-performance compute – is being shaped.

DEEPAK AGARWAL
Corporate Vice President of Silicon Design Engineering and Site Lead for AMD Bengaluru

"When the opportunity arose to relocate to India in 2005, I saw it not just as a personal move, but as a strategic one for AMD," Deepak recalls. "India had immense untapped engineering talent, and I believed we could build a high-impact silicon design centre here."

That was 2005. The team was six people in a rented office space. Fast forward to today and the site has grown to over 100 engineers, contributing to complex IP development, core complex die delivery, and global engineering collaboration. No longer a cost centre, AMD Bengaluru has emerged as a critical nerve centre. "We also took on critical, high-visibility